

Citi CSC Intern Interview Experience '23

About the company:

Citigroup Inc., commonly known as Citi, is indeed an American multinational investment bank and financial services corporation. Its headquarters are in New York City. Citi operates globally, offering a wide range of financial products and services to individuals, corporations, governments, and institutions.

Citi also has a presence in India and operates under the name Citi India. In India, Citi has established Citi Solution Centres, which are specialized centres focused on technology, processing, analytics, and financial processes. These solution centres play a crucial role in supporting Citi's operations and providing various services to its customers.

Citi's presence in India reflects its commitment to leveraging global talent and resources to deliver innovative solutions and efficient services to its clients worldwide.

Number of rounds: 3 (After shortlisting of candidates above 8.5 CGPA by CUIC)

- 1) Online Test
- 2) Technical Interview
- 3) HR Interview

ONLINE ASSESSMENT:

Platform: SHL AMCAT

The test has few basic requirements:

- A Personal Computer / Laptop.
- A Webcam connected with the System (Not required in case of Laptop with functional in-built Webcam)
- Smooth and uninterrupted Internet connectivity (throughout the testing session)

Duration of Assessment: 2 Hrs

The online assessment had 2 sections:

- **APTITUDE SECTION**
- **CODING SECTION**

45 mins of Aptitude questions-

In my experience, the aptitude questions in the assessment ranged from easy to medium difficulty. I found that calculating values and solving expressions took up a significant amount of time, making it a time-consuming process. What I noticed was that logical-based questions required careful attention because even though the question itself seemed easy; the answer options could be quite tricky.

Do not spend too much time on a single question. It's crucial to manage time effectively and not get stuck on challenging questions. Instead, make it a point to move on to the next question (Note You can't come back to unmarked question again)

What surprised me was that the aptitude round carried equal weightage as the coding round, highlighting its importance in the overall evaluation process. So, it's essential to prepare well for the aptitude section to maximize the chances of success.

75 mins of coding questions-

This section contained 2 questions. We could choose to code them in our preferred languages (Java / C++ is suggested)

1. Program to Print the Trapezium Pattern: Given 'num' which indicates number of lines. The task is to print a trapezium pattern in num lines. ([Program to Print the Trapezium Pattern - GeeksforGeeks](#))

2. Couldn't recollect the question: something related to map.

The questions were of easy difficulty, and I was able to pass all test cases in first question and 3-5 test cases in second question using brute force approach.

TECHNICAL INTERVIEW:

In my experience, this round was a face-to-face interview conducted physically at CUIC and lasted for 30 minutes. From Anna University, a total of 48 students, including myself, were shortlisted for this round. We were divided into four groups based on our domains: FXLM, Risk, Support, and TTS. I was assigned to the FXLM domain interview.

The interview commenced with the standard question of introducing myself. I understood that the answer I gave would create the first impression about me. Therefore, I decided to present my introduction in the form of a short story. I explained how I ended up pursuing computer science engineering at CEG after studying biology in school, why I chose this field, what I have learned from it, and shared my interests.

During the interview, I was asked about how I managed to understand computer science concepts and subjects despite having no prior knowledge before joining college. I shared my experience of how my first year of college was quite challenging, and I had to find ways to grasp the concepts. I explained that I sought guidance from seniors and actively engaged in projects for each subject, which allowed me to gain a practical understanding of the topics. Implementing the concepts practically helped me comprehend them better.

The interviewers also inquired about my projects, which I realized was an important question in the Citi intern interview. They were not solely interested in assessing my technical skills but also wanted to know about the innovation I brought to the projects and my knowledge of the languages, frameworks, and stack used. They emphasized how I collaborated with my teammates and showcased my leadership skills. I highlighted two high-quality projects that I could confidently present on my resume and to the interviewers.

Additionally, I was asked about a few object-oriented programming concepts and database management system concepts, although I couldn't recall the exact questions. Lastly, they presented me with a puzzle to solve. The puzzle involved placing ten balls in five lines in a specific manner (referring to the link: <https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/puzzle-10-balls-in-5-lines/>).

Towards the end of the interview, they gave me an opportunity to ask any questions I had, and then the interview concluded.

HR ROUND:

I am unable to explain about this round cause I had only 2 minutes of HR Round. The interviewer asked me to tell him about myself and asked me to leave :).

IMPORTANT TIPS:

- I have limited experience preparing for coding questions on coding platforms, and I consider myself fortunate to have received an easy question in my coding round. You can refer to the experiences of my other friends for more insights.
- When it comes to the aptitude round, it's important to practice time management by keeping track of the time taken to solve each question. Look for websites that offer aptitude questions and try to understand the underlying logic behind the solutions.
- Having a basic understanding of data structures, algorithms, computing complexities, and related concepts is beneficial.

- I recommend solving coding questions in Java or C++ rather than C or Python. It's often helpful to initially attempt a brute force method for coding questions, as it can satisfy most test cases. If you have no idea how to solve a problem, try hard coding specific solutions to satisfy the test cases.
- It's advantageous to have at least two solid projects that can enhance your resume. Ensure you have an in-depth understanding of your projects, including the problem statement and any novel aspects of your solutions.
- When preparing your resume, aim for a minimalistic approach. Include details that you are confident about and can answer during an interview. Order your projects and programming languages based on your level of confidence and knowledge. Avoid lying about any information on your resume and refrain from including things you are unsure about. Additionally, include any relevant extracurricular activities.
(<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1GxYBY-Wbn63foJq2PDWRysVOUvxCQv8Q/view?usp=sharing>)
- Before the interview, review last-minute preparation materials and frequently asked questions on object-oriented programming, database management systems, operating systems, data structures and algorithms, and popular puzzles.
- In Citi, the right attitude matters more than just technical skills. Be confident and demonstrate a willingness to learn and admit when you don't know something. Instead of simply saying "I don't know" to unknown questions in an interview, try to respond in a constructive manner. It's beneficial to have some knowledge about the company, the domain, and the role you are interviewing for at Citi.
- Lastly, it's worth noting that Citi is considered one of the easier companies to secure an internship with. They don't solely focus on technical skills. Stay confident and relaxed throughout the process.

Don't worry too much about the intern drive or give up in the middle. Sometimes luck plays a crucial role, and you will land up in a better place at right moment. All the best!!

Feel free to reach out:

+91 9790925246

surendirabalaji.n@gmail.com